

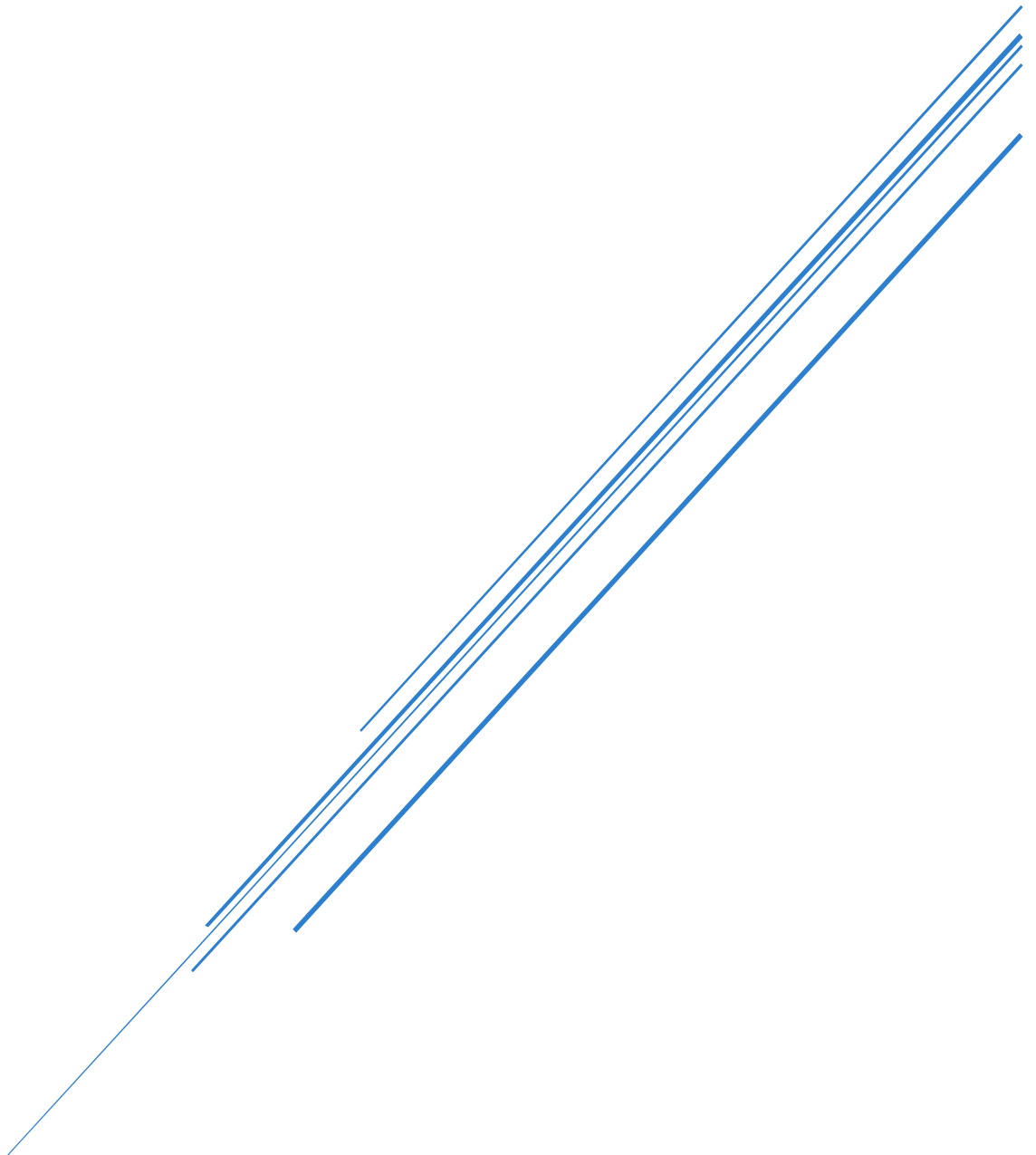
INFORMATION SYSTEMS: ICE

TASK 5

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Chosen App: Discovery App

Purpose of the Application:

The Discovery App serves as a central hub for users to manage their banking, medical aid, and insurance. It focuses on driving healthy habits through the Vitality rewards program, allowing users to be able to track their fitness goals, manage financial transactions and claim rewards within a single ecosystem.

Good Design Features:

- Consistency: The app can maintain a strict “Discover Blue” visual look. Actions buttons, iconography and typography are uniform across the Health, Bank and Vitality modules, helping the user feel as if they are in the same ecosystem. regardless of the task
- Closure: The Vitality Rings are a notable example of closure. When a user completes their weekly exercise goal, the ring will physically close and trigger a reward animation, providing a clear, satisfying endpoint to the user’s interaction for that goal.
- Human Interface Objects: The app makes use of recognizable digital metaphors. The “Vitality Wheel” mimics a physical spinning wheel and the digital medical aid cards have been designed to look like the physical plastic cards that the user are more familiar with, making them intuitive to find and use.
- Usability and Efficiency: High-frequency tasks, like “Scan to Pay” or “Find a doctor” are available via “Quick Actions” on the landing page, allowing more experienced users to bypass deep menus.

Design Flaws:

- Readability (Overcrowding): Since the app is trying to do everything (Bank, Life, Travel, Insure, Health), the navigation menus are typically five or six levels deep. This can eventually lead to “information overload” where trying to find a specific document like a tax certificate becomes a frustrating task through menus.
- Discoverability: While primary features are obvious, smaller but vital tools (such as the “Gap Cover” claims) are often buried deep into marketing banners for new discovery products, making them difficult for users to find when they need them.
- Readability (Contrast Issues): Some of the smaller text used in the “investment” or “detailed claims” views has low contrast or small font sizes, making it difficult for older users or those with visual problems to read on a mobile screen.

Suggested Improvements:

- Global Search Bar: Adding a persistent search function at the top of the app would allow for users to type “Tax Certificate” or “Blood Test” and go directly to the page, bypassing the Navigation hierarchy.
- Personalised Dashboard: Allowing users to customize their home screen by “pinning” their most used feature (e.g.: “Vitality-first” view) can improve Efficiency and Discoverability.
- Improved Breadcrumbs: Implement a visual “pathway” or breadcrumb trail at the top of sub-menus so that users can always know where they are within the deep structure of the app.

References:

www.discovery.co.za. (n.d.). *Medical Aid, Bank, Insurance, Invest & Vitality*. [online] Available at: <https://www.discovery.co.za/>.